

Ambulance Handover Escalation Guidance

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Ambulance Handover Pressure

Ambulance handover delays should be monitored as part of the wider urgent and emergency care pressure picture.

Operational teams should review the number of delayed handovers, delay duration, Emergency Department capacity, available assessment space and downstream bed flow.

Persistent handover delay may indicate pressure elsewhere in the patient pathway rather than an isolated ambulance problem.

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Coordinated Response

Where ambulance handover delay becomes significant, site coordination should bring together Emergency Department leadership, ambulance liaison, bed management and operational leadership.

The response should focus on safe patient flow, prioritisation of operational bottlenecks and removal of avoidable delays.

Handover escalation should be reviewed alongside wider organisational escalation arrangements.